TOASTMASTERS INTERNATIONAL · DISTRICT 121

ATK VPE Automation — User Manual

Complete Step-by-Step Operator Guide & Message Timing Handbook

The authoritative, end-user manual for the Advanced Toastmasters of Kerala (ATK) automation system. Explains in complete detail: the exact timing of every automated WhatsApp message, how role players interact via chat, and how the Vice President Education (VPE) operates the web planner and programme review interfaces without touching spreadsheets.

OPERATOR MANUAL | EXACT MESSAGE TIMINGS | WHATSAPP INTERACTION FLOWS | WEB UI WALKTHROUGH | ROLE-BY-ROLE GUIDES

SYSTEM NAME
ATK VPE Automation (MERN Stack Edition)

CLUB ORGANIZATION
Advanced Toastmasters of Kerala (Club #07842323 / ATK)

PRIMARY TIMEZONE
Asia/Kolkata (IST / UTC+5:30)

AUTOMATED DISPATCH HOURS
7:00 AM & 8:00 PM IST (with 1-Hour Tick Cycle)

WEB ACCESS URL
http://localhost:3000 / /programme-review

AUDIENCE
VPE, TMOD, Grammarians, Speakers, Evaluators & Members

1. How the Site & Automation System Work (The Big Picture)

1.1 The Operational Concept

The ATK VPE Automation system eliminates manual back-and-forth communication. Instead of the VPE messaging dozens of club members every week, the system acts as an **intelligent 24/7 digital assistant** that coordinates meeting planning autonomously.

The system operates across two linked environments:

📱 1. The WhatsApp Conversational Bot

Club members and role players interact directly inside WhatsApp. They receive interactive announcements, tap buttons to claim vacant meeting roles, submit speech project details, provide meeting themes, and submit Word & Idiom of the Day. No apps or passwords needed.

💻 2. The VPE Web Control Center

The VPE manages club operations through modern web interfaces:
• **The Web API / Flutter Dashboard**: Plan meetings, reorder agenda items with drag-and-drop, and monitor readiness scores.
• **The Programme Review Page**: 60-day visual lookahead to protect speech slots, place holds, and schedule educational sessions.

1.2 How Information Flows Through the System

Every action taken on WhatsApp or the Web instantly updates the central database and cascades to other role players:

- **When a member claims a role** on WhatsApp ➔ the meeting schedule is updated immediately, the role is marked filled, and role instructions are sent to the member.
- **When the TMOD submits the theme** ➔ the theme is saved and automatically broadcast to the General Evaluator, Table Topics Master, Speakers, Evaluators, Grammarian, and the VP Public Relations.
- **When the Grammarian confirms the Word & Idiom** ➔ the complete grammar package is formatted and delivered to the TMOD and VPE.
- **When a Speaker submits speech details** ➔ the Path, Level, Project, Title, and Time are verified and handed off to the Speech Evaluator and TMOD.

2. Master Chronological Timing Schedule

This master timetable details **exactly when every automated message is triggered**, the time of day it is sent, the recipient, and what condition initiates it:

Timeline	Time of Day	Event / Message	Recipient	Trigger Condition & Operational Logic
T-21 Days	1st of Month / Periodic	Programme Review URL	VPE	Monthly planning trigger. Delivers tokenized URL for the 60-day slot review.
T-14 to T-10 Days	7:00 AM IST	Speech Slot Invitation	Qualified Speakers	Evaluates member speech history; invites members who haven't spoken recently.
T-10 Days	Instant on Booking	Speech Booking Confirmation	Speaker	Triggered immediately when member claims speech slot. Protects the slot.
T-7 to T-5 Days	7:00 AM IST	Role Vacancy Announcement	Active Club Members	Detects unfilled roles in upcoming meeting. Sends `atk_role_reminder_v2` template.
T-7 to T-5 Days	Instant on Button Click	Interactive Role List Menu	Member	Triggered immediately when member taps `[View roles]` button on WhatsApp.
T-7 to T-5 Days	Instant on Selection	Role Claim Confirmation	Member	Triggered immediately when member selects role. Atomically reserves role.
T-6 Days	7:00 AM IST	Speaker Details Prompt	Confirmed Speakers	First prompt requesting Pathway, Level, Project, Title, and Timing.
T-6 Days	7:00 AM IST	Meeting Theme Request	TMOD	Prompts TMOD for meeting theme via copyable WhatsApp template.
T-5 & T-4 Days	7:00 AM & 8:00 PM IST	Theme Reminder (if pending)	TMOD	Sends reminder twice daily if TMOD has not yet submitted theme.
T-5 to T-2 Days	7:00 AM & 8:00 PM IST	Speaker Details Reminder	Speakers	Sends reminder twice daily if speaker details remain pending. Min 1 hr cooldown.
On Theme Submit	Instant on Reply	Cascading Theme Broadcast	GE, TTM, Speakers, Evaluators, Grammarian, VPPR	Autonomous trigger. Instantly delivers theme to all meeting participants and VPPR.
T-3 Days (or on Theme)	On Theme or 7:00 AM IST	Word of the Day Prompt	Grammarian	Theme-aware trigger. Starts as soon as theme is available, or T-3 fallback.
On Word Submit	Instant on Reply	Idiom of the Day Prompt	Grammarian	Acknowledges Word of Day and prompts for Idiom of Day format.
On Idiom Submit	Instant on Reply	Grammar Review & Buttons	Grammarian	Delivers full bundle review with buttons: `[Confirm]`, `[Edit Word]`, `[Edit Idiom]`.
On Grammar Confirm	Instant on Confirm	Grammar Package Handoff	TMOD & VPE	Triggered when Grammarian clicks Confirm. Delivers formatted bundle to TMOD.
T-3 to T-2 Days	7:00 AM IST	Role Introduction Prompt	Role Players	Prompts role players for custom 2-3 sentence introduction or default bio fallback.
T-2 Days	6:00 PM IST	Speech Details Handoff	Speech Evaluators & TMOD	Delivers speaker project objectives, title, and timing to assigned evaluators and TMOD.
T-1 Day	10:00 AM IST	Draft Agenda & Approval	VPE	Compiles full draft agenda; displays Control Center readiness score.
Meeting Day	8:00 AM IST	Meeting Day Final Reminders	All Role Players	Delivers arrival time, venue address/Zoom link, and final meeting agenda.

3. WhatsApp Member Interaction Manual (Message by Message)

This section shows **exact WhatsApp screens and messages** that club members see, explaining what buttons to tap and what text to send.

3.1 Flow 1: Vacant Role Announcement & Self-Selection

ATK VPE Automation
Hi Anoop,

ATK Meeting 452 is scheduled for Sunday, 26 October 2026 as planned.

Please tap below to see the available roles. Thank you! 😊 7:00 AM

🔘 View roles

Anoop (Member)
[Taps button: View roles] 7:05 AM

ATK VPE Automation
Here are the open roles for ATK Meeting 452. Please choose one from the list: 7:05 AM

📋 Select a Role (Interactive Menu)

Anoop (Member)
Selected: **Toastmaster of the Day (TMOD)** 7:06 AM

ATK VPE Automation
✅ **Role Confirmed!**

Thank you Anoop! You are now confirmed as the **Toastmaster of the Day** for ATK Meeting 452.

We will contact you shortly to collect your meeting theme. 7:06 AM

3.2 Flow 2: TMOD Meeting Theme Collection & Downstream Broadcast

ATK VPE Automation
Hi Anoop,

As Toastmaster of the Day for ATK Meeting 452, please reply with your chosen **Meeting Theme**.

Please reply in this format:
`Theme: <Your Theme Title>` 7:00 AM (T-6)

Anoop (TMOD)
Theme: Embracing the Uncomfortable 9:15 AM

ATK VPE Automation
✅ Thank you Anoop! Your theme **"Embracing the Uncomfortable"** has been saved and shared with your General Evaluator, Table Topics Master, Speakers, Evaluators, and Grammarian. 9:15 AM

3.3 Flow 3: Grammarian 2-Stage Word & Idiom Collection

The Grammarian workflow is designed to be 100% stress-free and accepts multi-line explanations or partial input:

ATK VPE Automation
Thank you for being the Grammarian for ATK Meeting 452. 😊

The meeting theme is *Embracing the Uncomfortable*.

WORD OF THE DAY

Please copy the next message, fill in the details, and send it back. 9:16 AM

ATK VPE Automation
Word:
Meaning:
Usage: 9:16 AM

Grammarian
Word: Fortitude
Meaning: Courage in pain or adversity
Usage: She endured her speech with great fortitude. 10:02 AM

ATK VPE Automation
Thank you! Your Word of the Day is received. ✅

IDIOM OF THE DAY

Please copy the next message, fill in the details, and send it back. 10:02 AM

ATK VPE Automation
Idiom:
Meaning:
Usage: 10:02 AM

Grammarian
Idiom: Bite the bullet
Meaning: To face a grim situation with courage
Usage: I decided to bite the bullet and take the speech slot. 10:05 AM

ATK VPE Automation
Please review your submissions for ATK Meeting 452:

Word of the Day: Fortitude
Meaning: Courage in pain or adversity
Usage: She endured her speech with great fortitude.

Idiom of the Day: Bite the bullet
Meaning: To face a grim situation with courage
Usage: I decided to bite the bullet and take the speech slot.

Please tap an option below: 10:05 AM

✅ Confirm | 🖍️ Edit Word | 🖍️ Edit Idiom

Grammarian
[Taps button: Confirm] 10:06 AM

ATK VPE Automation
🎉 **Grammarian Submission Complete!**

Your Word and Idiom of the Day have been confirmed and sent to your Toastmaster of the Day (Anoop) and the VPE. Thank you!

10:06 AM

3.4 Flow 4: Speaker Project Details Collection

ATK VPE Automation
Hi Priyesh,

You are confirmed as **Speaker 1** for ATK Meeting 452.

Please copy the next message, fill in your Pathways speech details, and reply:

7:00 AM (T-6)

ATK VPE Automation
Path:
Level:
Project:
Title:
Time:

7:00 AM (T-6)

Priyesh (Speaker)
Path: Presentation Mastery
Level: Level 2
Project: Effective Body Language
Title: The Silence Between Words
Time: 5-7 minutes

11:30 AM

ATK VPE Automation
✅ Speech details saved for **Speaker 1**!

Title: "The Silence Between Words"
Pathways: Presentation Mastery · Level 2 · Effective Body Language
Time: 5-7 minutes

These details have been shared with your Speech Evaluator. Good luck!

11:30 AM

4. VPE Web Management Guide: Using the Web App & Planner

4.1 Meeting Planning & Drag-and-Drop Reordering

The VPE operates through the **Web API / Flutter Web application**. The VPE never needs to open Google Sheets:

Step 1 — **Create a New Meeting** — Action: meeting.create

Click **"New Meeting"**, select the target Sunday date from the datepicker. The backend automatically populates the default meeting structure (TMOD, GE, TTM, Speakers 1-3, Evaluators 1-3, Timer, Ah-Counter, Grammarian).

Step 2 — **Assign Members Using Dropdowns** — Searchable Directory

Click on any role row and choose an active member from the searchable dropdown. The UI automatically enforces member IDs behind the scenes so name typos never break the database.

Step 3 — **Add Custom Educational Sessions** — Special Segments

To add an Education Session, Panel Discussion, or Induction Ceremony, click **"Add Item"**, select `type: "session"`, enter the title, and assign the presenter.

Step 4 — **Drag & Drop Agenda Reordering** — Authoritative Sequence

Grab any agenda row by its drag handle and move it up or down (for example, placing an Education Session before Table Topics). When you click **Save**, the backend preserves the exact sequence as positions 1 through N.

Step 5 — **Save as Draft vs Confirmed Plan** — Action: meeting.save

- **Save as Draft (`save_mode: "DRAFT"`)**: Saves your working plan without locking any slots.
- **Save Meeting Plan (`save_mode: "CONFIRMED"`)**: Confirms the plan and marks it `PLANNED`. Any vacant roles will be automatically picked up by the WhatsApp role-call engine.

4.2 Dashboard & Readiness Metrics (dashboard.get)

The VPE Dashboard provides instant status indicators for all upcoming meetings:

Readiness Category	Ideal Ratio	Meaning & Action Required
Roles Filled	`6/6`	TMOD, GE, TTM, Timer, Ah-Counter, Grammarian. If ratio is low, trigger role reminder broadcast.
Speakers Confirmed	`3/3`	Prepared speakers confirmed for slots 1, 2, and 3.
Evaluators Paired	`3/3`	Every confirmed speaker must have an assigned Speech Evaluator.
Speaker Details	`3/3`	Pathways projects, speech titles, and timing received and validated.
Theme & Grammar	`Ready`	TMOD theme submitted and Grammarian Word + Idiom approved.

5. VPE Web Management Guide: Using the 60-Day Programme Review

5.1 Accessing the Review Page

On the 1st of each month (or upon request), the system sends the VPE a direct link with an embedded security token:
`http://localhost:3000/programme-review?token=<HMAC_TOKEN>`
This page opens on any phone, tablet, or desktop browser with no login screen required.

5.2 Reviewing Slots & Taking Action

The page displays every meeting scheduled for the next 60 days. Each meeting shows Slot 1, Slot 2, and Slot 3. For each slot, the VPE can choose an action from the dropdown menu:

1. Keep Open

Leaves the slot available for club members to book through speech targeting invitations.

2. Hold for Session (VPE Hold)

Reserves the slot for an educational session or workshop. Holds never auto-release and prevent members from claiming the slot.

3. Confirm Session

Opens input fields: *Session Type, Presenter Name, Session Title / Topic, and Time Allotted (minutes)*. Locks the session into the agenda.

4. Request Speaker Move

Used when a speaker needs to reschedule. **Crucial safety feature:** The speaker's current slot remains fully protected until they accept a new date!

5.3 Saving Your Review

Once you have made your changes across the 60-day window, scroll to the bottom and click the black **"Save review"** button. The status changes to green: `Saved. Slot changes recorded.` The changes are synchronized across MongoDB Atlas and the scheduling database immediately.

6. Role-by-Role Quick Reference Cheat Sheets

👔 For the Vice President Education (VPE)

- **Weekly Routine**: Check the Flutter Dashboard on Monday morning. Review the Readiness ratio for Sunday's meeting.
- **Vacant Roles**: If roles are vacant at T-7 days, the bot handles it. You only need to step in manually if roles remain open by T-2 days.
- **Programme Review**: Complete your 60-day slot review once a month via the `/programme-review` link.

🎭 For the Toastmaster of the Day (TMOD)

- **When Contacted (T-6 Days)**: Reply on WhatsApp with your theme: `Theme: <Title>`.
- **Theme Propagation**: You do not need to message anyone—the bot distributes your theme to all role players automatically.
- **Handoff Package (T-2 Days)**: The bot delivers a full package containing: Word of the Day, Idiom of the Day, Speaker details, and role player bios for your stage introductions.

📖 For the Grammarian

- **When Contacted (T-3 Days or upon theme)**: Copy the Word format message, fill in Word, Meaning, Usage, and send.
- **Stage 2**: Copy the Idiom format message, fill in Idiom, Meaning, Usage, and send.
- **Final Step**: Tap `[Confirm]` on the review screen. Done!

🎤 For Prepared Speakers

- **Slot Booking**: Tap `[Select Slot]` when the invitation arrives on WhatsApp.
- **Details Prompt (T-6 Days)**: Copy the 5-line template: Path, Level, Project, Title, Time. Reply in one message.

🧐 For Speech Evaluators

- **Handoff (T-2 Days)**: Receive your speaker's Pathways project objectives, title, and timing via WhatsApp.
- **Coordination**: Contact your speaker directly before the meeting to discuss their personal evaluation goals.

👥 For All Club Members

- **Weekly Role Call**: When the announcement arrives, tap `[View roles]`, pick your role from the list, and receive instant confirmation.

7. Frequently Asked Questions & Troubleshooting

Q: What happens if a member makes a typo when submitting Word of the Day?

The bot's parser is case-insensitive and ignores extra spaces or leading prompt text. If a field is missing (e.g. they forgot "Usage:"), the bot saves what was submitted and sends a polite follow-up asking only for the missing usage.

Q: What if two members try to claim the same role at the same time?

The engine executes atomic verification. The first member to tap gets the role. The second member receives a courteous notification: "*That role was just filled. Here are the remaining available roles...*" and is shown the updated list.

Q: Why did I receive a reminder at 8:00 PM?

To keep meetings on schedule, the system operates two daily reminder slots: **7:00 AM IST** and **8:00 PM IST**. If a time-sensitive submission (such as a speech title or TMOD theme) is still pending, a reminder is sent during the next slot with a minimum cooldown period to prevent spam.

Q: Does the system send WhatsApp messages in DEV / Test mode?

No. In development mode (`WA_SEND_MODE=TEST`), messages are only delivered to verified phone numbers listed in `WA_TEST_RECIPIENTS` . Club members never receive test messages.

Support & System Administration

For technical inquiries, database migrations, or WhatsApp Cloud API template updates, contact the ATK Technology & Automation Committee.